

Word family: **trend / trends / trended / trending / trendy / trendiness**

Base word: trend

Forms: trends, trended, trending

Related forms: trendy, trendiness

Part of speech: noun (名詞) / verb (動詞) / related adjective and noun forms (相關形容詞及名詞)

Your sentence:

> “In a city defined by cramped flats, soaring rents and limited public space, this **trend** may appear understandable at first glance.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **trend** means a **general pattern of change or behaviour that is becoming increasingly common over time**.

The writer is referring to the growing practice of using restaurants and coffee shops for tutorial lessons and other lengthy educational activities.

繁體中文： **趨勢；一種逐漸變得更普遍、並顯示出某個發展方向的現象或行為模式**

中文翻譯：

> “...this **trend** may appear understandable at first glance.”

「.....這種**趨勢 / 現象**乍看之下似乎可以理解。」

Here:

trend = 越來越多人把餐廳當成補習或學習空間的發展趨勢

1. **trend = general direction of change or development (趨勢) — 趨勢；走向**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: A general direction in which a situation, behaviour, condition, or set of data is changing over time.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The **trend** of using cafés as study spaces is becoming more noticeable.”

「把咖啡店當作學習空間的**趨勢**越來越明顯。」

Practice 2

> “The figures show a downward **trend**.”

「這些數據顯示出下降**趨勢**。」

Practice 3

> “There has been a clear **trend** toward smaller households.”

「家庭規模縮小的**趨勢**十分明顯。」

****trend = 某件事情隨時間持續向某個方向發展的整體模式****

Common:

- * upward trend
- * downward trend
- * long-term trend
- * growing trend
- * trend toward something
- * trend in something

2. ****trend = popular style, behaviour, or interest (潮流) — 潮流；流行趨勢****

****Trend**** can mean something that becomes fashionable or widely popular for a period.

Practice 4

> “Oversized jackets are a major fashion **trend**.”

「寬鬆外套是目前重要的時尚**潮流**。」

Practice 5

> “The app started a new social-media **trend**.”

「這個應用程式帶起了一股新的社交媒體**潮流**。」

****trend = 在某段時間內迅速受到很多人採用、模仿或關注的流行做法 / 風格****

Common:

- * fashion trend
- * social-media trend
- * design trend
- * lifestyle trend
- * latest trend

This overlaps with Meaning 1 but emphasizes **popularity and imitation**, not merely statistical direction.

3. **trend** = pattern shown by data/statistics (數據) — 趨勢線；數據走勢

In statistics, economics, business, science, etc., **trend** can mean the underlying direction visible in a series of observations.

Practice 6

> “The data reveal a gradual upward **trend**.”

「數據顯示出逐步上升的**走勢**。」

Practice 7

> “Researchers examined the long-term **trend** in temperatures.”

「研究人員分析了氣溫的長期**趨勢**。」

trend = 從一組按時間排列的數據中可以看出的整體變化方向

For strict counting, this belongs to Meaning 1, but the quantitative use is important enough to surface explicitly.

4. **trend** = tendency in attitudes or behaviour (社會 / 思想) — 傾向；風向

Trend can refer to a broader direction in beliefs, behaviour, policy, culture, or social attitudes.

Practice 8

> “The survey suggests a **trend** toward more flexible working.”

「調查顯示社會正出現更彈性工作模式的**傾向 / 趨勢**。」

Practice 9

> “The policy reflects a wider social **trend**.”

「這項政策反映了更廣泛的社會**趨勢**。」

Again, this is part of the general-development sense rather than a separate core meaning.

5. **trend** = verb: move/develop in a particular direction (動詞) — 呈現趨勢；朝.....發展

As a verb, **trend** means to develop or move gradually in a particular direction.

Practice 10

> “Prices are **trending** upward.”

「價格正**呈上升趨勢**。」

Practice 11

> “Public opinion has **trended** toward greater support.”

「公眾意見逐漸**朝更支持的方向發展**。」

trend + direction = 數據、態度、情況等逐漸朝某個方向變化

Common:

- * trend upward
- * trend downward
- * trend higher
- * trend lower

This is a major modern verb branch.

6. **trend** = become widely discussed/popular online (網絡) — 成為熱門話題；登上熱搜

A very important modern use:

> **to trend**

can mean to become one of the most widely discussed, searched, or shared subjects on an online

platform.

Practice 12

> “The video began to **trend** overnight.”

「那段影片一夜之間開始**爆紅** / 成為熱門內容。」

Practice 13

> “The topic was **trending** on social media.”

「這個話題正在社交媒體上**成為熱門話題**。」

trend online = 在網絡平台上迅速獲得大量關注、討論、搜尋或分享

This is sufficiently conventional and modern to count as a distinct learner-facing verb use.

7. **trending** = currently popular online (網絡形容詞) — 熱門的 ; 正在流行的

Practice 14

> “The site displays **trending** topics.”

「這個網站會顯示正在**熱門討論的話題**。」

Practice 15

> “This is one of the most **trending** videos today.”

「這是今天其中一段最**熱門**的影片。」

More idiomatic English often prefers:

> one of today's top trending videos/topics

trending = 目前在網絡上得到大量關注、分享或討論的

8. **trend** = extend/run in a geographical direction (地理 / 地質) — 延伸 ; 走向

In geology, geography, and technical description, **trend** can mean that a feature extends in a particular direction.

Practice 16

> “The mountain range **trends** north-east.”

「這條山脈**向東北延伸**。」

Practice 17

> “The fault line **trends** roughly north to south.”

「這條斷層線大致**呈南北走向**。」

trend = 地形、斷層、岩層等朝某個方向延伸

This is a genuine specialist verb sense.

It is not especially important for everyday learners, but it belongs in a comprehensive sweep.

9. **trend** = prevailing tendency/style of a period (時代風格) — 時代風尚；主流方向

In formal or historical discussion, **trend** can refer to a broad intellectual, artistic, economic, or cultural movement.

Practice 18

> “The novel reflects several literary **trends** of the period.”

「這部小說反映了當時幾種文學**思潮 / 發展趨勢**。」

Practice 19

> “The movement challenged dominant cultural **trends**.”

「這場運動挑戰了主流文化**潮流**。」

This bridges Meaning 1 and Meaning 2.

For core counting, I would not split it separately.

Related form: **trendy**

****Trendy**** means fashionable or currently popular.

Practice 20

> “The area is full of ****trendy**** cafés.”

「那個地區有很多很****時髦 / 流行****的咖啡店。」

Practice 21

> “She bought a ****trendy**** jacket.”

「她買了一件很****時尚****的外套。」

****trendy** = 符合目前潮流、很受歡迎或很時髦的******

Depending on tone, ****trendy**** can sometimes imply that something is fashionable mainly because it follows the latest trend rather than because it has lasting value.

That contrast appeared in your previous jacket passage:

> ****classic rather than trendy****

= 經典耐看，而不是只追逐一時潮流。

Related form: ****trendiness****

****Trendiness**** means the quality of being fashionable or strongly associated with current trends.

Practice 22

> “The neighbourhood’s ****trendiness**** attracted new businesses.”

「這個社區的****時髦感 / 潮流程度****吸引了新商戶。」

Valid, but lower frequency than ****trendy****.

Important distinction: ****trend vs pattern****

****pattern****

means any repeated or recognizable arrangement/behaviour.

trend

specifically suggests **direction or change over time**.

- > pattern of behaviour
- > trend toward remote work

A pattern does not necessarily increase, decrease, or develop.

Important distinction: **trend vs tendency**

tendency

means an inclination or likelihood for something to happen.

trend

usually suggests that the pattern is actually observable over time.

- > tendency to worry
- > trend toward later marriage

So **tendency** can exist within a person; **trend** is often broader and evidenced by repeated behaviour/data.

Important distinction: **trend vs fashion**

fashion

often refers to what is currently stylish or socially popular, especially clothing/design.

trend

is broader and can apply to:

- * economics
- * demographics
- * technology
- * behaviour
- * data
- * fashion

> fashion trend

shows that **trend** is the directional/popularity pattern within fashion.

Important distinction: **trend** vs **fad**

fad

= intense but usually short-lived popularity.

trend

may last much longer and may represent a genuine structural shift.

> short-lived fad

> long-term trend

Calling something a fad often implies it will disappear.

Important distinction: **trend** vs **movement**

movement

can mean an organized collective effort or broad social/artistic phenomenon.

trend

does not require organization or conscious coordination.

> environmental movement

> social trend

Important distinction: **trend** vs **direction**

direction

is very broad.

trend

means an observed general direction over time.

> direction of travel

> trend in prices

Important distinction: **trend vs trajectory**

trajectory

literally means the path of a moving object and figuratively the longer-term path of development.

trend

focuses more on the general direction indicated by repeated observations.

> career trajectory

> employment trend

Important distinction: **trendy vs fashionable**

fashionable

means currently popular or stylish.

trendy

often emphasizes being noticeably aligned with the latest trends.

> fashionable restaurant

> trendy café

Trendy can sound more youthful, current, or sometimes slightly superficial.

Grammar note: **trend toward/towards**

A very common construction:

> a trend toward smaller homes

> a trend towards online learning

Both **toward** and **towards** are standard.

Grammar note: **trend in**

- > trend in prices
- > trend in consumer behaviour
- > trend in employment

This identifies the area where the change is being observed.

Grammar note: **trend upward/downward**

As a verb:

- > prices trend upward
- > sales trend downward

This is especially common in financial, statistical, and analytical writing.

Countability note

Trend is countable:

- > a trend
- > several trends

Examples:

- * a growing trend
- * recent trends
- * long-term trends
- * fashion trends

The general concept may also appear without much emphasis on counting:

- > trend analysis

but the noun itself is normally readily countable.

Useful compound: ****megatrend — 大趨勢****

A ****megatrend**** is a very large-scale, long-term trend affecting society, economies, technology, demographics, etc.

This is a useful lexical extension but not a separate base-word sense.

Useful compound: ****trend line / trendline — 趨勢線****

In charts/statistics, a ****trend line**** is a line showing the general direction of data.

This belongs to the data/statistics branch.

Useful expression: ****buck the trend — 逆勢而行；與大趨勢相反****

Practice 23

> “The company managed to ****buck the trend**** and increase sales.”

「這家公司成功****逆勢而行****，令銷售額上升。」

****buck the trend = 表現或發展方向與整體普遍趨勢相反****

This is an important fixed expression.

Useful expression: ****set/start a trend — 帶起潮流****

Practice 24

> “The designer helped ****set a trend**** for simpler clothing.”

「那位設計師帶起了簡約服裝的****潮流****。」

This belongs to the popularity branch.

Useful expression: ****follow a trend — 跟隨潮流 / 趨勢****

Practice 25

> “Many businesses are following the same **trend**.”

「很多企業正在跟隨同一個**趨勢**。」

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **trend**
* **trends**
* **trended**
* **trending**
* **trendy**
* **trendiness**

Useful compounds/constructions:

* trend toward
* trend in
* upward/downward trend
* trending topic
* set a trend
* follow a trend
* buck the trend
* trend line
* megatrend

The word has one very broad central idea—**a direction of development or popularity over time**—but modern online **trend/trending** has become conventional enough to deserve explicit treatment.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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trend — direction of change	某種情況、行為或數據隨時間向某方向發展的整體趨勢
trend — popular style/behaviour	某段時間廣泛受到採用、模仿或關注的潮流 / 流行趨勢
trend — statistics/data	從一組數據中可觀察到的整體上升、下降或變化方向
trend — verb	情況、數值或態度逐漸朝某個方向發展

trend — online	在網絡上迅速成為大量討論、搜尋或分享的熱門內容	
trending	目前受到大量網絡關注 / 正在流行的	
trend — geology/geography	地形、斷層、岩層等朝某方向延伸；專門	
trendy	符合當前潮流、時髦而受歡迎的	
trendiness	時髦 / 緊貼潮流的程度	
buck the trend	與整體普遍趨勢相反地發展	

For your original sentence

> “...this **trend** may appear understandable at first glance.”

The exact meaning is:

trend = 越來越多人把咖啡店和快餐店當成長時間補習、面試練習或做工作紙場所的發展現象

So:

> **this trend**

= **這種愈來愈普遍的趨勢 / 現象**

The writer is not calling it a **fashion trend**. Here, **trend** means an observable social behaviour becoming increasingly common.

For your database, I would count **3 genuinely useful core meanings** for **trend**:

1. **general direction/pattern of change over time**
2. **currently popular style, behaviour, or practice**
3. **verb/online extension — develop in a direction or become a widely discussed online topic**

I would keep statistical trends under #1, geological **trend** as a lower-priority domain extension, and keep **trendy / trending / trendiness** as family extensions rather than multiplying the core unnecessarily.